11-22 第2篇

阅读理解（记叙文） My First Trip to the Dentist, Alone

① When I was much younger, Mum had always gone with me to the dentist. I would sit in the soft blue chair; she would stand behind it and hold my hand. This year the situation was different. Mum had a **long work meeting on Wednesday afternoon**, and Dad was out of the city on a business trip. My right lower molar had been **aching quietly** for three days — not a loud pain, but a small, stubborn pulse whenever I drank cold water. At breakfast, Mum put down her chopsticks and said gently, "You are fourteen. Can you go to Dr Liu's clinic by yourself at 15:30? I will pay on the app in advance." I looked at my porridge for five seconds. Then I said, "Yes."

② At 14:50 I put my school bag in my locker, took the small paper health card, and walked out of the school gate. Dr Liu's clinic was only fifteen minutes away, on the second floor above the flower shop on Pingyuan Street. I had walked past the building a hundred times, and I knew the small white sign: *"Pingyuan Dental — Children and Adults — 08:30–18:00."* Today, for the first time, I walked up the narrow stairs instead of past them.

③ At the door, a small bell rang. The clinic smelled of **mint and warm disinfectant**. Two other patients were waiting: an old grandfather reading a newspaper, and a small boy, about six years old, sitting on his mother's knee. The boy's eyes were red; he had clearly been crying earlier. I sat in the far chair and looked at my phone. I sent Mum a short line: *"Arrived. Two people in front of me."* She replied quickly: *"Take your time. Breathe. If you feel unsure, ask. That's all."*

④ The receptionist, Ms Chen, called my name at 15:25. "Lin Ming? Please come in." Her voice was calm and warm, the way a good adult speaks to someone only slightly younger. I walked into the small inner room. Dr Liu was washing his hands, turned, and smiled. "You came by yourself today?" "Yes," I said, trying to keep my voice even. He nodded, **as if this were perfectly normal** — and looking back, maybe this was his first kindness of the day: **treating my small act of independence as not special, not a performance, simply something a fourteen-year-old could do**.

⑤ He asked about the tooth. I pointed to the lower right. He asked if it hurt with cold water. I said yes. He asked if it hurt when I bit down. I said not really. He put on a small blue mask and looked inside with a small round mirror. Then he explained clearly: *"There is a small soft hole on the side of the tooth. It is not deep yet. I will clean it and fill it with a light white material. Ten minutes. It will not hurt, but it may feel strange."* He paused. "Do you have any questions?"

⑥ I had one question. I did not say it right away; I took a breath, then said, "Can I hold the small bell, in case I need you to stop?" Dr Liu laughed softly. "Of course. That is a very good question. Hold the small silver bell in your left hand. Shake it any time." The small silver bell was on the side table — the kind that kindergartens use for tiny songs. It felt light and serious at the same time.

⑦ The filling took nine minutes. The light was very bright. The small drill made a high, thin sound. I shook the bell once, about three minutes in, because my jaw was tired; Dr Liu stopped at once and let me rest for thirty seconds. He did not say, "Don't be afraid." He did not say, "Be brave." He simply said, "Good. Tell me when you are ready." Those short, calm sentences were better than any big praise. I felt, for the first time, like a small but real adult in a room of adults.

⑧ When it was finished, Dr Liu gave me a small sheet of paper: **"Do not eat anything cold or hard for two hours; rinse gently after meals for three days; if pain comes back, call us."** He did not give me a sticker or a lollipop; I was a bit past that. Instead, he shook my hand. A proper handshake, the same way he had shaken the grandfather's hand before me. Ms Chen stamped my health card at the front desk, told me to take the small stairs slowly, and said gently, "See you in six months, Ming."

⑨ I walked down the stairs into the late afternoon light. My mouth felt a little numb on one side; the rest of me felt strangely tall. I bought a warm soy milk at the small shop near the flower stand, and sat for a minute on the low wall, looking at the sky. I thought about three small things: **Dr Liu's calm sentences; the small silver bell in my left hand; Mum's short message "Breathe. If you feel unsure, ask."** None of them were about the tooth. They were about **how adults quietly help a child become a little bigger** — by giving her a clear task, a small tool, and the trust to come home on her own. I walked home slowly, not proud, just quiet. That walk, more than the filling, was the part I will remember.

注释： dentist 牙医；molar 臼齿；clinic 诊所；disinfectant 消毒剂；filling 补牙材料

根据短文内容，选择最佳答案。

1. Why did the writer go to the dentist alone?

A. Because she wanted to prove she was brave.
B. Because her right lower molar had been quietly aching for three days; Mum had a long work meeting on Wednesday afternoon and Dad was out of the city on a business trip, so Mum gently asked whether she could go to Dr Liu's clinic at 15:30 by herself, and she said yes.
C. Because Mum refused to go.
D. Because the school forced her.

2. What was Dr Liu's "first kindness of the day" to the writer, according to Paragraph ④?

A. He gave her a free lollipop.
B. He treated her small act of independence as not special, not a performance — simply something a fourteen-year-old could do; this quiet attitude made her independence feel natural and real.
C. He praised her loudly in front of other patients.
D. He shouted at her for being late.

3. What did the writer ask Dr Liu before the filling began?

A. Whether she could leave.
B. Whether she could hold a small silver bell in her left hand, in case she needed him to stop.
C. Whether she could have sweets.
D. Whether she could turn off the light.

4. What did Dr Liu say during the filling, which the writer later valued so much?

A. "Don't be afraid."
B. "Be brave."
C. "Good. Tell me when you are ready." — short, calm sentences; better than big praise, because they made her feel like a small but real adult in a room of adults.
D. "Hurry up, we are busy."

5. What does the writer mean by saying the walk home, more than the filling, was the part she will remember?

A. The filling was unimportant.
B. She liked the flower shop.
C. The real lesson was how adults quietly help a child become a little bigger — by giving her a clear task, a small tool, and the trust to come home on her own; the walk was when she felt this for the first time.
D. She preferred walking to dentistry.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第①段家庭背景与母亲安排
【解析】牙疼 + 父母不在 + 温柔询问直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

2.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第④段"第一份善意"
【解析】"不当表演、不当特别"直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

3.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑥段请求
【解析】小银铃直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

4.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑦段"Good. Tell me when you are ready."
【解析】直引与解释。A、B、D 均错。故选 C。

5.
【答案】C
【题型】推理判断题
【定位】第⑨段主题总结
【解析】"清晰任务、一件小工具、信任"的主旨。A、B、D 均偏离。故选 C。